batters play the turning ball. Fitness and sharpness has been an asset of ours – we keep going no matter what the heat is and our standards do not drop.

Sachin is the key wicket. If we can get him early, the score 64/2, then it will send a statement to the rest of his batting line-up – Pujara, Dhoni, Sehwag and a young batter called Virat Kohli – that we are actually going to win here. As dusk sets in, I take the breath at the end of the mark, feel the seam in my fingers. He's been stuck on the crease a bit, allowing himself time to react to the ball because of the deadness of the pitch. If I can get one to hoop inside, utilise the reverse swing, it might take him by surprise. I run in, towards the dusty foreground where so many have struggled and we are striving, and roll my fingers inside the ball. It's intentionally shorter and, as Tendulkar goes to play at it away from his body, his feet not moving and then jumping as if to react, it kicks back from the surface sharply, going between bat and pad. He is bent over when the sound of the stumps pierces the Nagpur atmosphere. Then it is just silence surrounding me, bent over myself out of semi-disbelief, hugging Matt Prior's midriff.

It's the last time I get Tendulkar, the ninth time in my career, and the most anyone would ever get him out. MS Dhoni, the Indian captain, would say in defeat that he felt I was the difference. There were about eight of us that accolade could go to. At 30 years old, I feel like I'm just getting started, finally learning the hardest trick of them all – to extract something out of subcontinental pitches and do it against a team of Indian greats.